

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name _____

Date _____

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

Ladder 1

H A R M

Start here

1

The opposite of soft

2

It has four fingers and a thumb

3

A group that plays music together

4

A safe place to keep money

T A N K

Finish here

Ladder 2

R U L E

Start here

1

An animal that is half horse, half donkey

2

A small animal that digs tunnels underground

3

An opening dug in the ground

4

The place where you live

S O M E

Finish here

Ladder 3

C O S T

Start here

1

You wear it outside when it is cold

2

A black rock that burns to make heat

3

A little bit cold

4

To make food hot and ready to eat

L O O K

Finish here

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

	H	A	R	M	<i>Start here</i>
1	H	A	R	D	The opposite of soft
2	H	A	N	D	It has four fingers and a thumb
3	B	A	N	D	A group that plays music together
4	B	A	N	K	A safe place to keep money
	T	A	N	K	<i>Finish here</i>

Ladder 2

	R	U	L	E	<i>Start here</i>
1	M	U	L	E	An animal that is half horse, half donkey
2	M	O	L	E	A small animal that digs tunnels underground
3	H	O	L	E	An opening dug in the ground
4	H	O	M	E	The place where you live
	S	O	M	E	<i>Finish here</i>

Ladder 3

	C	O	S	T	<i>Start here</i>
1	C	O	A	T	You wear it outside when it is cold
2	C	O	A	L	A black rock that burns to make heat
3	C	O	O	L	A little bit cold
4	C	O	O	K	To make food hot and ready to eat
	L	O	O	K	<i>Finish here</i>